stantly stressed. Transmigration is not directly referred to though the soul is conceived as immortal.

In later hymns and the *Brāhmaṇas,* the development of thought takes three distinct lines: monotheism, monism, and ritualism. Identity in the conception of different gods suggests monotheism. A supreme God is not yet conceived, however, an attempt is made to discover a common power behind all the gods. God, or *Prajāpati,* is such a power. The monistic tendency traces the world not to a creator but to a single primal cause, diversifying itself into the universe, which anticipating the later Upaniṣadic Absolute is described as *Tat Ekam,* or That One. Here, therefore, the focus of attention turns from the concrete and the external to the abstract and the internal, which is later followed up in the *Upaniṣads.*

Ritualism, representing the effort to gain the favor of the gods through sacrificial gifts, culminates in the *Brāhmaṇas.* It is just another way of looking at the concept of *Rta,* according to which a correct sacrifice inexorably brings its own good result.

THE UPANIṢADS

Upaniṣads (700-600 B. C.) literally means "secret teaching." Forming the concluding part of the *Vedas,* they are also called the *Vedānta* and *Āraṇyakas*—or the forest books. They mark a distinct step beyond the *Brāhmaṇas.* Of the major *Upaniṣads,* about ten are the most celebrated, the *Brihadāraṇyaka* and the *Chāndogya* being the most important among them. Their exalted idealism and lofty teachings have had a lasting influence upon the Indian mind. Much of the subsequent Indian philosophy, in one way or another, draws inspiration from the *Upaniṣads.*

In the *Upaniṣads* the stress is, not on the traditional performance of action *(Karma-mārga),* but on the knowledge of the ultimate truth as a means to the final liberation of man *(Jñāna-mārga).* Apart from this shift in emphasis, the *Upaniṣads* inaugurate a new era of "looking within" for the reality of the universe as opposed to the Vedic perception of the *Puruṣa* as a macrocosmic reality.

Thought here is devoted chiefly to the concept of the *Ātman* and the *Brāhmaṇ.* The quest after *Brāhmaṇ* as the all-pervasive spirit springs from the desire to discover a Supreme Controller of man and nature. By progressive elimination, this ultimate reality is found by the *Upaniṣads* to be none other than man's own Self, which is also the *Brāhmaṇ.* This alone is real. But the problem is: If the *Ātman* alone is real, what happens to the reality of the external world? Though the universe is a reality, say the *Upaniṣads,*